

	Third Grade Theme: Growing Inspiration								
	Inspired To Sparkle: Positive Choices, Self-Awareness, and H.E.A.R.T. Skills		Inspired by My Community: Togetherness Through Resource Sharing and Civic Responsibility		Inspired by Extraordinary Ecosystems: The Interwoven Lives of Plants and Animals		Inspired by Remarkable People: Everyday Heroes, Innovators, Activists, and More!		Inspired by Nature’s Rhythms: Weather Phenomena, Natural Cycles, and New Beginnings
	September		October	November	December	January	February	March	April May
Science	FOSS: Science Launch - We will launch science by asking: What is a scientist? Together, we will discover that scientists are inspired by their curiosity as they explore the world around them. - We will set up our journals to document our learning. - We will each select an animal that will be researched later in the year—one that inspires us. We will sketch and paint our animals, and display our beautiful art. - As we learn our science expectations, we will discuss how our H.E.A.R.T. skills—honor, empathy, accountability, respect, and teamwork are necessary during science.		FOSS: Structures of Life - We will learn that all living things, even plants, rely on shared resources—like water, sunlight, and soil. - We will dissect seeds and learn about their anatomy. - We will test how different conditions like water, sunlight, and soil affect plant growth & survival. - We will study the features of insects & arachnids: <i>Insects</i> work together in their own communities to share resources and take care of their colonies. <i>Arachnids</i> are responsible members of their community, keeping their ecosystems healthy by controlling pests and recycling nutrients.		FOSS: Structures of Life - We will explore how animals grow, change, and adapt to survive, reflecting on how their amazing abilities inspire wonder in the natural world. - Next, we will examine the wonders of the human body—our bones, fingerprints, and inherited traits—discovering how our own structures connect us to the living world and to one another. - Through these investigations, we will find inspiration in the connections among all living things and the ways each plant, animal, and human contributes to the web of life.		FOSS: Motion and Matter - We will explore forces like pushes and pulls, taking inspiration from astronaut Mae Jemison. - We will investigate patterns of motion, studying how objects move, just like a roller coaster engineer. - We will study magnetism, learning about scientist Michael Faraday, who used magnets to discover how electricity works. - We will experiment with mixtures, taking inspiration from innovator George Washington Carver, who combined plants to make peanut butter, soaps, paints, and other products.		FOSS: Water and Climate - We will explore nature’s rhythms and weather phenomena. - We will look at patterns in nature and discuss ways that weather and water are connected. - We will learn about Earth’s natural cycles, including the water cycle. - We will explore the temperature's effect on water.
Social Studies	- We will kick off our thematic learning journey by exploring the meaning of inspiration. - We will ponder these guiding questions: <i>What does inspiration mean to you, and how can it help you in your life?</i> <i>How does inspiration affect motivation?</i> <i>Who or what inspires you to sparkle?</i> - We will discuss the importance of H.E.A.R.T. skills, learning that demonstrating honor, empathy, accountability, respect, and teamwork not only build character, but inspire others to do the same. - We will engage in read alouds, discussions, collaborative activities, art projects, and engineering games, working on positive choices, self-awareness, and H.E.A.R.T. Skills.		Chapter 1: Our Environment - We will learn about Earth’s resources and explore how using them responsibly helps our community thrive while protecting the planet for everyone. Chapter 2: Economics - We will learn how people get what they want and need. We will explore how sharing goods strengthens our communities and helps meet everyone’s needs. Chapter 3: Communities Build a Nation - We will study Native American people & look at how early communities built the U.S. We will see how cooperation, respect, and teamwork helped early communities succeed and how these lessons can guide us in being responsible citizens today.		Chapter 4: Government, Landmarks, Symbols - We will explore state offices, leaders, and their functions, reflecting on the values of liberty, equality, and justice. - We will also learn that everyone’s experiences and backgrounds shape how they see the world, inspiring us to listen, understand, and respect different perspectives. Chapter 5: Citizenship and Civics - We will study why rules and laws exist, how to be responsible citizens, and ways we can take action to stand up for our rights, discovering how ordinary people can make an extraordinary difference.		Chapter 6: A Growing Nation - We will explore how life has changed throughout history, looking at ways people traveled, found homes in America, communicated, and shared new ideas that shaped our nation. - We will take a closer look at American heroes, discovering how their courage, creativity, and determination continue to inspire us today.		Chapter 7: Celebrating Our Communities - We will conclude the year by celebrating culture through the arts and honoring our nation’s diversity. - We will share and explore traditions, stories, and music from around the world, discovering how learning about others can inspire appreciation, connection, and understanding in our global community.
Reading	Genre: Children’s Picture Books - We will compare and contrast the themes, settings, and events of different stories. We will look closely at the life lessons each story teaches us, finding commonalities between them. - We will identify differences between the characters’ points of view and our own, by noticing how they think, feel, and make choices. We will reflect and discuss how we might act in similar situations. - We will learn how illustrations give us clues about a character’s emotions, the mood of the story, or important details that the words alone may not show. Book Titles: - What Does It Mean to Be Kind? - The Juice Box Bully - The Potato Chip Champ - Adventures on the Can Do Trail - Spaghetti in a Hot Dog Bun - Becoming a Good Creature - Making Smart Choices - Ruby the CopyCat - We’re Better Together - Pinocchio - My Mouth is a Volcano - Diversity Is... - Acorn Was a Little - The I Heard - Tiny Troubles - Just Ask - Sally Sore Loser - Do Unto Otters - SAY Something		Genre: Fantasy / Novel Study James and the Giant Peach - We will analyze the novel’s characters, events, & themes. - We will explore how James and the insects share their unique skills and resources—like when the Centipede uses his many legs to help move the peach—asking how these actions help the group succeed and what that teaches us about working together. - We will examine the choices characters make, such as when James decides to help everyone escape the dangers they face, and discuss how these decisions show civic responsibility and care for others. - We will analyze how each character’s talents—like the Grasshopper’s music or the Spider’s webs—contribute to the group’s success, reflecting on how different strengths can unite a community to overcome challenges. Book Title: - James and the Giant Peach by Roald Dahl		Genre: Informational Texts Environments and Animals - We will ask and answer thoughtful questions to dig deeper into what we read about ecosystems. - We will uncover the main idea, break down key details, and explain how they connect. - We will navigate text features and search tools like experts to discover even more information about creatures in our world. Book Titles from MyView Curriculum: - Patterns in Nature - Weird Friends: Unlikely Allies in the Animal Kingdom - Wolf Island - Welcome Back, Wolves! - Wolves Don’t Belong in Yellowstone - Nature’s Patchwork Quilt: Understanding Habitats - Wetlands Other Texts: Nature’s Children Animal Book Series		Genre: Biographies about Heroes and Historical Fiction Excerpts - We will read biographical texts about inspirational people to uncover the main idea their stories tell. - We will highlight key details that show how their actions made a difference. - We will compare and contrast how different texts reveal the qualities of heroes and remarkable people from the past. Book Titles from MyView Curriculum: - Below Deck - Excerpts from Little House on the Prairie - Mama Miti - Poems About Heroes - The House That Jane Built - Frederick Douglass - Milton Hershey - Sonia Sotomayor by Barbara Kramer Other Texts: Who Is/Who Was Book Series		Genre: Children’s Lit/Novel Charlotte’s Web - We will journey through the classic children’s novel <i>Charlotte’s Web</i>, exploring characters, settings, and key events. - We will uncover themes of natural cycles, new beginnings, and the power of friendship, reflecting on how acts of kindness and courage can spark positive change. - We will explore different perspectives—our own and the characters’—learning how seeing through someone else’s eyes can inspire understanding. - We will perform a Charlotte’s Web Play for students and parents. Book Title: - Charlotte’s Web by E.B. White Titles from MyView Curriculum: - Earthquakes, Eruptions, and Other Events - Do Tornadoes Really Twist
Writing	Journaling about H.E.A.R.T. Skills		Writing about Characters (Opinion)		Writing Animal Books (Informational)		Biography Reports (Informational)		Creative Writing (Narrative)
Math	Unit 1: “Math Is..” - We will explore and interact with the math world around us. Unit 2: Addition and Subtraction - We will learn strategies for adding and subtracting to 1,000. - We will work on rounding to the tens and hundreds place.		Unit 3: Multiplication and Division - We will learn about multiplication & division fact families. Unit 4: Use Patterns to Multiply - We will use patterns to multiply by 0, 1, 2, 5, and 10. Unit 5: Use Properties to Multiply - We will use multiplication properties to multiply numbers by 3, 4, 6, 7, 8, and 9.		Unit 6: Connect Area and Multiplication - We will explore ways to determine area such as using unit squares and multiplication strategies. Unit 9: Use Multiplication to Divide - We will use multiplication to solve division problems. Unit 10: Use Properties and Strategies - We will apply mathematical properties to problems.		Unit 7: Fractions - We will learn the basics of fractions, plot them on number lines, and sketch models. Unit 8: Fraction Equivalence & Comparison - We will find equivalencies and compare fractions. 11: Perimeter - We will calculate the perimeter of different shapes.		Unit 12: Measurement and Data - We will learn to solve problems involving time, weight, length, and volume. - We will interpret various types of graphs. Unit 13: Analyzing Shapes - We will learn to describe and classify polygons, quadrilaterals, and shapes.

Health	• Safety in the home and in the world	• Community Health and Safety • Illness and Injury Prevention, Nutrition	• Functions of the Eyes and Body • Growth and Development, Cycle of Family Life	• Self Worth/Mental & Emotional Health • Environmental/Consumer Health, Physical Fitness	• Disease and Illness Prevention • Substance Abuse Prevention
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Component 1 Read Aloud Picture Books

(yellow highlight = we read it)

Honor

- **Acorn Was a Little** – We will be honest about our feelings and abilities as we grow up, learning to face challenges with patience.
- **The I Heards** – We will practice honor by thinking before we speak, learning how gossip and rumors can affect others.
- **Sally Sore Loser** – We will be honest about our emotions and handle challenges with fairness in mind.
- **SAY Something!** – We will practice honor by using our voices to stand up for fairness and do what is right.

Empathy

- **Becoming a Good Creature** – We will learn about courage, kindness, and empathy by seeing the world through animals’ experiences.
- **Be Kind** – We will see how one small act of thoughtfulness can spread and inspire others to be empathetic.
- **Just Ask** – We will appreciate different abilities and learn to understand others by asking questions.
- **What Does It Mean to Be Kind?** – We will discover many ways we can demonstrate empathy through simple acts of thoughtfulness.

Accountability

- **Adventures on the Can Do Trail** – We will build confidence, perseverance, and accountability through the power of saying “I can do it.”
- **Making Smart Choices** – We will learn how to make thoughtful decisions by thinking ahead and considering consequences.
- **The Juice Box Bully** – We will stand up to unkind behavior and demonstrate that accountability matters.
- **Ruby the CopyCat** – We will learn that acting authentically, rather than mimicking someone else, is a form of personal accountability. We will take responsibility for how we act and embrace our own unique qualities.
- **Pinocchio** – We will learn that making good choices and listening to your conscience is an important part of Pinocchio’s journey.

Respect

- **The Potato Chip Champ** – We will learn that true friendship comes from gratitude and respecting others, appreciating their feelings and choices rather than focusing on material possessions.
- **Spaghetti in a Hot Dog Bun** – We will respect ourselves and others by embracing what makes each of us unique and standing up to bully behavior.
- **Do Unto Others** – We will treat others with respect and act in a way we would like to be treated.
- **My Mouth is a Volcano** – We will learn the importance of listening and waiting your turn to speak through the story of a boy who learns to control his outbursts.

Teamwork

- **We’re Better Together** – We will thrive as a team by combining our unique talents and celebrating what makes each of us special.
- **Diversity Is...** – We will celebrate the many ways people are different and why those differences make us stronger as a team.
- **Tiny Troubles** – We will work cooperatively to solve problems as a team.